

Lecture-8

“ఒం గ్రిం డ్నెం నెంట్స్ నెంట్స్ నెంట్స్”

continuing from lecture 7 we discussion the carrier transport in a semiconductor we discussed Drift & Diffusion Equations which we have deduced Heuristically.

i.e Equation that provides for the current Density of Electrons & holes in the semiconductor.

→ In doing so we defined Some Parameters Diffusion coefficients, Mobilities & conductivities

→ It is convenient now to go through these parameters to have an Idea about the order of Magnitudes of each parameter.

→ First of all the mobilities & Diffusion Coefficients in the Drift-Diffusion equations are not independent of each other

It can be demonstrated that when we consider the electrons

$$D_n = \frac{k_B T}{q} \mu_n$$

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Semiconductor Equations — V

Einstein's relationships

$$D_n = \frac{k_B T_L}{q} \mu_n$$

$$D_p = \frac{k_B T_L}{q} \mu_p$$

Room Temperature

At $T_L = 300$ K one finds for the thermal voltage

$$\frac{k_B T_L}{q} = \frac{1.38 \times 10^{-23} \text{ J/K } 300 \text{ K}}{1.60 \times 10^{-19} \text{ C}} \approx 26 \text{ mV}$$

$$\frac{q}{k_B T_L} \approx 38 \text{ V}^{-1}$$

we shall see that
→ it appears in the
exponent of expression
that determines
the current of the
PN Junction of
a Diode

$$\mu = \frac{q \langle \tau \rangle}{m^*} \approx \frac{1.60 \times 10^{-19} \text{ C } 0.25 \times 10^{-12} \text{ s}}{0.4 \times 10^{-30} \text{ kg}} = 10^3 \frac{\text{cm}^2}{\text{Vs}}$$

Estimation of
Diffusion
Constant

$$D = \frac{k_B T_L}{q} \mu \approx 25 \frac{\text{cm}^2}{\text{s}}$$

at $T_L = 300$ K

Conductivity

$$\sigma_n = q \mu_n n \approx 10^{-16} \frac{\text{cm}^2}{\Omega}$$

$$n = \begin{cases} 10^{-12} (\Omega \text{ cm})^{-1}, \\ 10^{-6} (\Omega \text{ cm})^{-1}, \\ 10 (\Omega \text{ cm})^{-1}, \\ 10^6 (\Omega \text{ cm})^{-1}, \end{cases}$$

$$\begin{aligned} n &= 10^4 \text{ Insulator} \\ n &= 10^{10} \text{ Intrinsic Silicon} \\ n &= 10^{17} \text{ Doped Silicon} \\ n &= 10^{22} \text{ Conductor} \end{aligned}$$

Concentration
of Electrons.
based on the
conductivity of
a Material

with $[n] = \text{cm}^{-3}$. It is useful to introduce the net thermal recombination rate $U_{n(p)}$ and the net non-thermal generation rate $G_{n(p)}$, for the conduction (valence) band, such that

$$W_n \doteq G_n - U_n, \quad W_p \doteq G_p - U_p.$$

$$\mu = \frac{q \langle \tau \rangle}{m^*}$$

q : Electron charge

$\langle \tau \rangle$: statistical average of
the momentum Relaxation
Time

m^* : Effective Mass

$\langle \tau \rangle$: Realistic value for this is around
Pico seconds (10^{-12} s)

m^* : Effective Mass of an Electron is lesser
than the free Electron Mass

So, we take $0.4 \times 10^{-30} \text{ kg}$

Real mass of Electron = $0.9 \times 10^{-30} \text{ kg}$

→ So Globally we can Assume that

$$\text{mobility} = 1000 \frac{\text{cm}^2}{\text{Vs}}$$

→ To continue to discuss this model that describes the Transport in a semiconductor.

It is convenient to distinguish some symbols

like we did in the splitting of Global continuity Equation into two individual continuity equations for Holes & Electrons

$$\frac{\partial n}{\partial t} + \text{div}(n v_n) = w_n \quad \text{Electrons}$$

$$\frac{\partial p}{\partial t} + \text{div}(p v_p) = w_p \quad \text{Holes}$$

w_p, w_n net Generation rates of Holes & Electrons

→ These two equations EMBED all the types of transitions that change the population either of conduction Band or Valence Band in a given VOLUME.

→ In many cases, it's convenient to distinguish what are the reasons for these transitions?

So, In all cases if we have a transition of Electron or Hole from CB to VB or vice versa.

or even from a Trap belonging to the Gap into a Band or vice versa

All these transitions any how imply the exchange of Energy with something else.

→ For several reasons, it is convenient to distinguish based on what entity is exchanging the ENERGY with electron (or) Holes

→ Therefore, we classify the transitions depending on other entity which exchanges energy with Electron.

ex:- Exchange of Energy by e^- or hole with nucleus of the atom when there is a collision.

→ This is such an important interaction that it is given a special symbol we split K_n & ω_p in two parts and one part describes the transitions that involves collisions with Nuclei of the Crystal.

→ Since the vibrational Energy of Nuclei depends on Lattice Temperature, these types

of Transitions are called **THERMAL TRANSITIONS**.

→ There are also other Transitions

Electron - Electron Transition

Electron - Impurity Transition

Electron - photon Transition

All these Transitions are called

Non-THERMAL interactions.

with $[n] = \text{cm}^{-3}$. It is useful to introduce the net thermal recombination rate $U_{n(p)}$ and the net non-thermal generation rate $G_{n(p)}$, for the conduction (valence) band, such that

$$W_n \doteq G_n - U_n, \quad W_p \doteq G_p - U_p.$$

→ $W = \underbrace{G_n}_{\substack{\text{Non Thermal} \\ \text{Generation} \\ \text{Rate}}} - \underbrace{U_n}_{\substack{\text{Thermal} \\ \text{recombination} \\ \text{Rate}}}$

$G_n \Rightarrow$ Total no. of electrons that enter the Conduction Band per unit volume in Time
 +
 Total no. of electrons that exit the CB per unit volume in Time
 (for Reasons that are not collisions with Lattice i.e. Non thermal collisions)

U_n : It is customary to describe as Recombinations $\therefore$ we put negative sign in the equation

Total no. of electrons that exit CB due to THERMAL collisions
 +

Total no. of e^- s that enter CB due to THERMAL collisions

**

Similarly, we define G_p & U_p



By Assuming Quasi-Static Approximation.

Semiconductor Equations — VI

Within the semiconductor region

poisson's equation split into Two parts

$$\text{div } \mathbf{D} = q(p - n + N), \quad \mathbf{D} = -\epsilon_{sc} \text{grad } \varphi$$

$$\frac{\partial n}{\partial t} + U_n - \frac{1}{q} \text{div } \mathbf{J}_n = G_n, \quad \mathbf{J}_n = q\mu_n n \mathbf{E} + qD_n \text{grad } n$$

$$\frac{\partial p}{\partial t} + U_p + \frac{1}{q} \text{div } \mathbf{J}_p = G_p, \quad \mathbf{J}_p = q\mu_p p \mathbf{E} - qD_p \text{grad } p$$

Within the insulator region

$$\text{div } \mathbf{D} = q N_{ox}, \quad \mathbf{D} = -\epsilon_{ox} \text{grad } \varphi$$

$$n = p = 0, \quad \mathbf{J}_n = \mathbf{J}_p = 0$$

They constitute a system of non-linear, partial differential equations of the first order, in the unknowns φ , n , p , and $\mathbf{D}$, $\mathbf{J}_n$, $\mathbf{J}_p$. The coefficients are μ_n , μ_p , D_n , D_p . The data are $N(\mathbf{r})$, $N_{ox}(\mathbf{r})$. In turn, U_n , U_p , G_n , G_p can be expressed as functions of the unknowns. By introducing the expressions of $\mathbf{D}$, $\mathbf{J}_n$, $\mathbf{J}_p$ into the divergence operator, one obtains a system of PDEs of the second order.

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We remember we have Poisson's equation that is necessary to calculate the electric potential and the Poisson's equation is what is left of Maxwell's equations. Because, we have accepted the Quasi-Static Approximation.

→

$$\frac{\partial n}{\partial t} + U_n - \frac{1}{q} \operatorname{div} \mathbf{J}_n = G_n, \quad \mathbf{J}_n = q\mu_n n \mathbf{E} + qD_n \operatorname{grad} n$$

$$\frac{\partial p}{\partial t} + U_p + \frac{1}{q} \operatorname{div} \mathbf{J}_p = G_p, \quad \mathbf{J}_p = q\mu_p p \mathbf{E} - qD_p \operatorname{grad} p$$

Here, we can see the continuity equation with $\cancel{w}_n$ represented as $G_n - U_n$

$$\frac{\partial n}{\partial t} + \operatorname{div}(n v_n) = w_n$$

Since

$$\mathbf{J}_n = q n v_n$$

$$n v_n = \frac{\mathbf{J}_n}{q}$$

q is ve for electron

$$\frac{\partial n}{\partial t} - \frac{1}{q} \operatorname{div}(\mathbf{J}_n) = G_n - U_n$$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{\partial n}{\partial t} + U_n - \frac{1}{q} \operatorname{div}(\mathbf{J}_n) = G_n$$

↓
As shown in the Book

→

$$\mathbf{J}_n = \underbrace{q\mu_n n \mathbf{E}}_{\text{Drift}} + \underbrace{qD_n \operatorname{grad} n}_{\text{Diffusion}}$$

$$\mathbf{J}_p = q\mu_p p \mathbf{E} - qD_p \operatorname{grad} p$$

→ we may have some fixed charge in the Insulator

Within the insulator region

$$\text{div } \mathbf{D} = q N_{\text{ox}}, \quad \mathbf{D} = -\epsilon_{\text{ox}} \text{grad } \varphi$$

$$n = p = 0, \quad \mathbf{J}_n = \mathbf{J}_p = 0$$

They constitute a system of non-linear, partial differential equations of the first order, in the unknowns φ , n , p , and $\mathbf{D}$, $\mathbf{J}_n$, $\mathbf{J}_p$. The coefficients are μ_n , μ_p , D_n , D_p . The data are $N(\mathbf{r})$, $N_{\text{ox}}(\mathbf{r})$. In turn, U_n , U_p , G_n , G_p can be expressed as functions of the unknowns. By introducing the expressions of $\mathbf{D}$, $\mathbf{J}_n$, $\mathbf{J}_p$ into the divergence operator, one obtains a system of PDEs of the second order.

→ For semiconductors we have ^{system} 6 PDE'S
because we have partial derivatives
w.r.to to space because of Divergence
operators and due to the Gradient operators
As we also have PD w.r.to Time

*** The unknowns of the equation are

Electric potential ϕ
Electron Concentration n
Hole Concentration p

} Scalar unknowns

& we also have

Electric Field

E

Current density

J_n & J_p

→ Then we have coefficients like

μ_n, μ_p, D_n, D_p

→ Data is Doping profile

$N(x), N_{ox}(x)$

→ U_n, U_p, G_n, G_p which can be expressed in terms of unknowns

*

$$\text{div } \mathbf{D} = q(p - n + N), \quad \textcircled{1} \quad \mathbf{D} = -\epsilon_{sc} \text{grad } \varphi \quad \textcircled{2}$$

if we substitute $\textcircled{2}$ in $\textcircled{1}$ we get a Laplacian which is again a scalar and we can eliminate the vectors.

* we can do the same thing with

$$\frac{\partial n}{\partial t} + U_n - \frac{1}{q} \text{div } \mathbf{J}_n = G_n, \quad \mathbf{J}_n = q\mu_n n \mathbf{E} + qD_n \text{grad } n$$

$$\frac{\partial p}{\partial t} + U_p + \frac{1}{q} \text{div } \mathbf{J}_p = G_p, \quad \mathbf{J}_p = q\mu_p p \mathbf{E} - qD_p \text{grad } p$$

Substitute J_n, J_p in the continuity equations

Note *** We can reduce the system with
6- 1st order equations to a system
with 3- 2nd order equations

in which we only have to deal with
 ϕ, n, p This is what we follow
to find Numerical solution of
Equations.

→ From now we will use this Mathematical
Formulations of Semiconductor Devices.

From Now on, we will use these mathematical
models to describe the functioning of
Semiconductor devices.

→ If we look at the Transport equations
which provide current densities.

$$J_n = q \mu_n n E + q D_n \text{grad} n$$

$$J_p = q \mu_p p E - q D_p \text{grad} p$$

They are of the Binomial form

→ It is possible to introduce a manipulation that essentially amounts to changing the unknown functions. To transform transport equations into a form called MONOMIAL

→ We can do this by introducing Auxiliary unknown functions that are called Quasi-Fermi Potentials

These two unknown functions are indicated by

$$\phi_n(r, t), \phi_p(r, t)$$

dependent on space & time

→ We impose that the electron concentration can be written as

Semiconductor Equations — VII

Quasi-Fermi potentials

Define $\phi_n(r, t)$, $\phi_p(r, t)$, such that:

$$n = n_i \exp \left[\frac{q(\phi - \phi_n)}{k_B T_L} \right],$$

$$p = n_i \exp \left[\frac{q(\phi_p - \phi)}{k_B T_L} \right]$$

In equilibrium, $\phi_n = \phi_p = \phi_F$. It is

$$\frac{k_B T_L}{q} \text{grad } n = n \text{ grad}(\phi - \phi_n), \quad \frac{k_B T_L}{q} \text{grad } p = p \text{ grad}(\phi_p - \phi)$$

$$\mathbf{J}_n = -q\mu_n n \text{ grad } \phi + q \frac{k_B T_L}{q} \mu_n \text{ grad } n = -q\mu_n n \text{ grad } \phi_n$$

$$\mathbf{J}_p = -q\mu_p p \text{ grad } \phi - q \frac{k_B T_L}{q} \mu_p \text{ grad } p = -q\mu_p p \text{ grad } \phi_p$$

Q Why do we adopt these new definitions
 $\phi_n(r, t)$, $\phi_p(r, t)$?

Ans If we are in the Equilibrium condition
we remember 'n' can be written as

$$n = n_i \exp\left[\frac{q}{k_B T_L} (\phi - \phi_F)\right]$$

→ Fermi potential

∴ The two auxiliary functions

$\phi_n(r, t)$, $\phi_p(r, t)$ are new auxiliary
unknowns that apply in the general case of
the model. They have a property that at
Equilibrium

$$\phi_n = \phi_p = \phi_F$$

Q How are these two additional unknowns
useful?

well, by taking expression of 'n' and take
a Gradient of it.

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$$n = n_i \exp\left[\frac{q(\phi - \phi_n)}{k_B T_L}\right]$$

$\text{grad}(n) = \nabla(n)$ → Similar representation

$$\Rightarrow \text{grad}(n) = n_i \text{grad}\left[\exp\left[\frac{q(\phi - \phi_n)}{k_B T_L}\right]\right]$$

$$\Rightarrow n_i \exp\left[\frac{q(\phi - \phi_n)}{k_B T_L}\right] \cdot \frac{q}{k_B T_L} \text{grad}(\phi - \phi_n)$$

$$\Rightarrow \text{grad}(n) = n \cdot \frac{q}{k_B T_L} \text{grad}(\phi - \phi_n)$$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{k_B T_L}{q} \cdot \text{grad}(n) = n \cdot \text{grad}(\phi - \phi_n)$$

Similarly

$$\frac{k_B T_L}{q} \cdot \text{grad}(p) = p \cdot \text{grad}(\phi_p - \phi)$$

→ Now, we simply replace the expression of $\text{grad}(n)$ into the Drift-Diffusion equation.

we have from above

$$J_n = q \mu_n n E + q D_n \text{grad } n$$

&

$$D_n = \mu_n \frac{k_B T_L}{q}$$

$$E = -\text{grad } \phi$$

put $\text{grad}(n)$ & D_n into the current density equation.

$$J_n = -q \mu_n n (\text{grad } \phi) + q \underbrace{\frac{k_B T_L}{q} \mu_n \text{grad}(n)}_{\downarrow}$$

$$\Rightarrow J_n = -q \mu_n n (\text{grad } \phi) + q \mu_n \underbrace{\frac{k_B T_L}{q} \text{grad}(n)}_{\downarrow n \text{ grad}(\phi - \phi_n)}$$

$$J_n \Rightarrow -q \mu_n n \text{grad}(\phi) + q \mu_n n \text{grad}(\phi - \phi_n)$$

$$\Rightarrow -q \mu_n n \text{grad}(\phi) - q \mu_n n \text{grad}(\phi_n - \phi)$$

$$\Rightarrow -q \mu_n n \text{grad}(\phi + \phi_n - \phi)$$

$$\vec{J}_n \Rightarrow -q\mu_n n \text{ grad } \phi_n$$

ప్రపంచంలో ఒకటి వింటల్లో ఎన్నో ముం
గమనించలేము. ఈ SDC subject పొడ
అంతే.

కానీ ఈ subject ని పరిపూర్ణంగా
అన్వేషించాము.

$\vec{J}_e$ Rudan Sir $\vec{J}_e \vec{J}_e$ Rudan
Sir

➤ This is the expression of current density
in a Monomial form as if $-\text{grad}(\phi_n)$
is a psuedo Field. embedding both
drift and diffusion components of
the Current Density.

→ Similarly we can do it Holes

Q

When are these expressions useful?

They are useful in devices in which

one type of current is dominant which typically happens in MOS Devices.

* For

Unipolar Devices:
(Dominant carriers)

It is preferable to calculate
the current using the
Quasi Fermi potential

Bipolar Devices: It is preferable to use
(Both carriers contribute) customary definition
of Drift Diffusion
Equation.

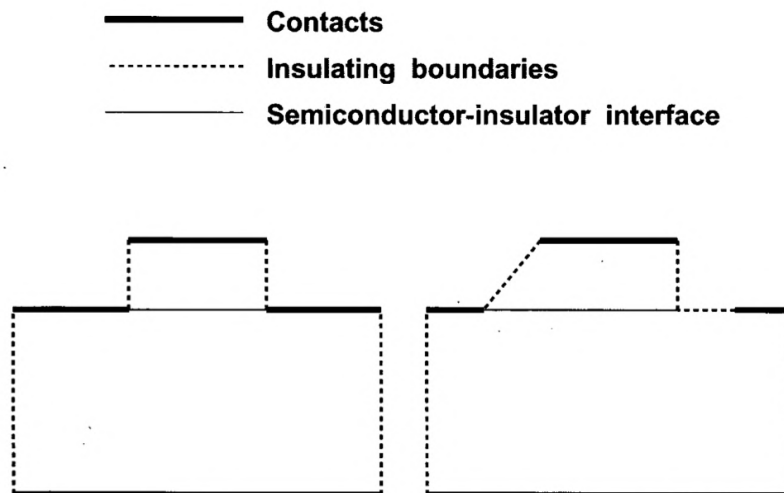
→ Other issue related to Mathematical
model of Semiconductor Devices is
of course the issue of Boundary Conditions
Because we have Equations that
contain the unknown functions and
derivatives w.r.to space.

They also contain derivatives w.r.to Time.

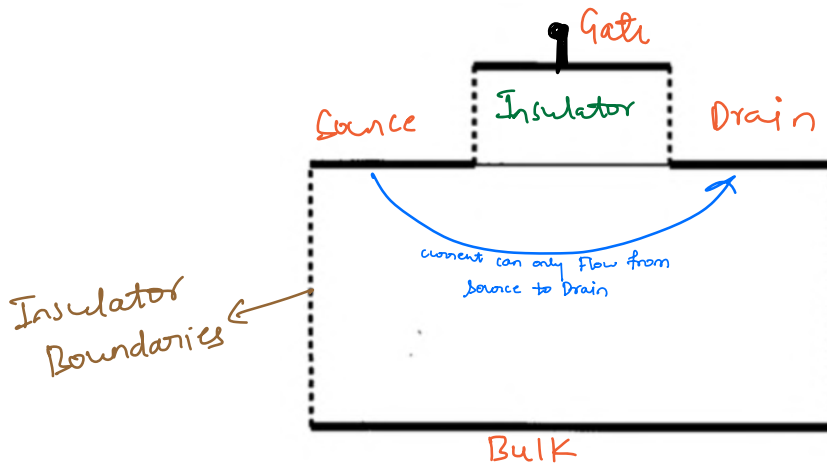
* For derivatives w.r.to TIME we must provide Initial conditions every time

In Space, we have to prescribe the Boundary conditions.

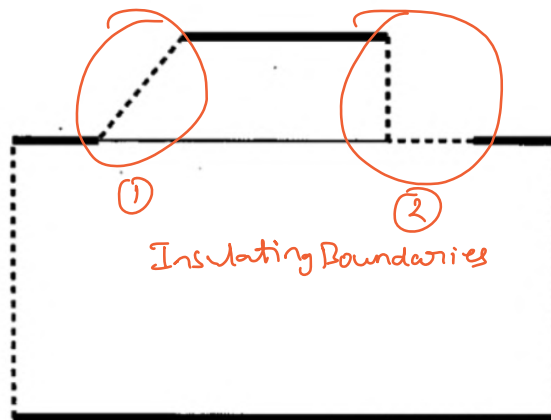
→ To discuss this issue we make use of Typical example of an MOS Transistor.



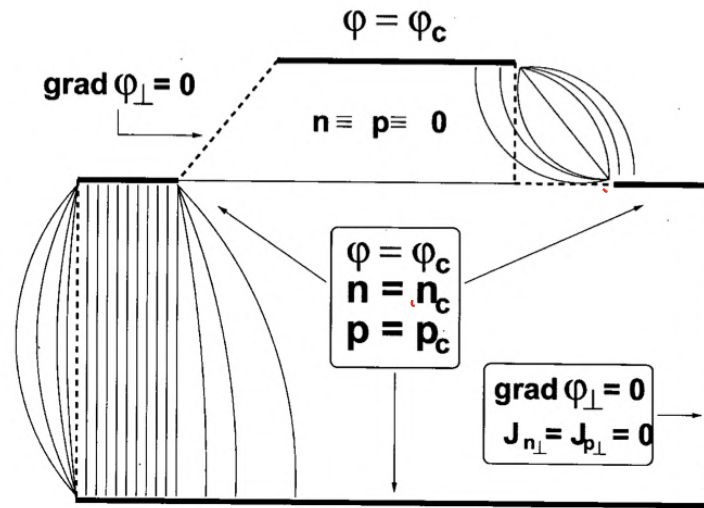
→ This is very schematic



→ Realistic Representation



* with Short Source & Drain contacts
 Then insulating Boundaries ^{for oxide} has two types
 But, we will see that slope ^① is the
 correct one to describe Insulator Boundary
 Condition.



we remember when we consider a semiconductor device model.

*** we can group the equations in order to have a three 2nd order equations w.r to space

(i) First Equation

The 1st equation has unknown the electric potential ϕ This is the poisson's Equation.

(ii) Second Equation

It has unknown that is the

electron concentration and

(iii) Third equation

has unknown the hole concentration.

→ let's start with Poisson's Equation which is the 2nd order PDE with

(ϕ) Electric potential as unknown.

→ we remember from Calculus that when we have a 2nd order equation over a domain - The mathematical problem is well posed if the Boundary conditions are such that the solution exists and is unique.

→ A type of Boundary Conditions that are suitable for Poisson's equation is like this.

(i) we must prescribe the

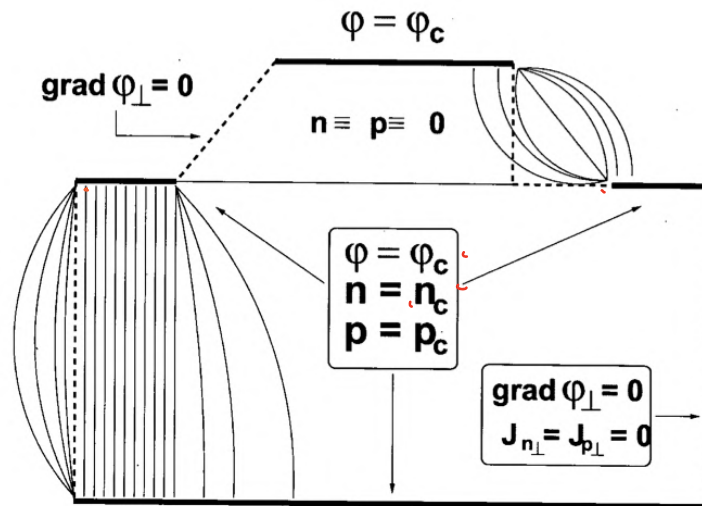
value of the unknown along the portion
of a Boundary and the normal derivative
of the unknown along the remaining
portion.



Q

Can we do this with our
example
of MOS device ?

?



Contacts



Insulating Boundaries

→ At the contacts we have electric

potentials because we have voltage generators typically applied to the contacts.

The value of Electric potential at the contact is prescribed.

- This is a Good Boundary Condition because, The Electric potential is the unknown of the equation and it's prescribed along the contact.
- The contacts are not made of semiconductor. They are typically made of METALS. There are interfaces b/w Metal & Semiconductor & Metal & Insulator if we consider Gate Contact.
- When we have interface b/w two materials we have a change in Electric potential. & This change is sometimes referred to as the difference in the work functions

of the two materials.

If, we take Drain contact - if we apply $5V$ to the semiconductor underneath Drain contact has the potential that is not equal to $5V$, It is equal to

$5V$ - Difference in the work function



→ But, This difference is given that is known so it is possible from the contact voltage to also deduce the voltage of the semiconductor that is attached to the Contact.

→ So, For contacts we do have a good Boundary Conditions.

and this is indicated as

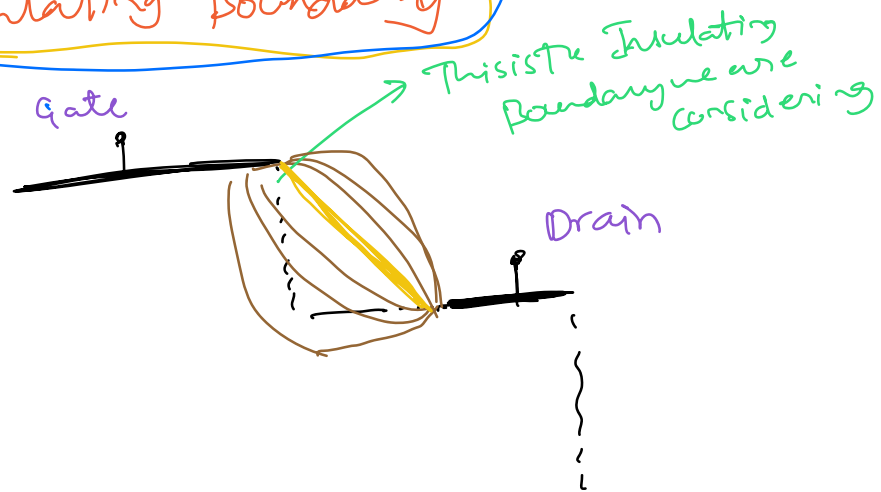
$$\phi = \phi_c$$

in the figure

The value of the electric potential ^{of semiconductor} underneath the contact is given by the electric potential of the contact.

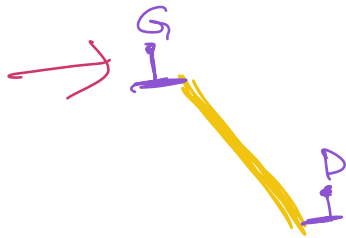


→ Insulating Boundary



Assume we apply $2V$ to the Drain
 $3V$ to the Gate

The thin lines that we can see **Drain lines**
 are the **Field lines** in that Region. The
 start from Gate & close at the Drain
 contact.



There is one **Straight** Field line which
 goes from Gate to Drain

Along this field line the **component**
 $\perp$ to this Field line is ZERO.

i.e. Electric Field is Fully aligned along
 the straight line.

ಎಲೆಕ್ಟ್ರಿಕ್ ಫೀಲ್ಡ್ ಪೂರ್ಣವಾಗಿ ಸ್ವಲ್ಪ

ಇದೇ ಲಘು ವಾಕ್ಯ 1^{ನೇ} ಲಘು ಲಘು ಲಘು
ಎಷ್ಟು ಲಘು. # Solo

→ It is preferable to select the Boundary along this straight line for the Insulator b/w Gate & Drain.

$$\text{grad } \phi_{\perp} = 0$$

This is also a Good Boundary condition.

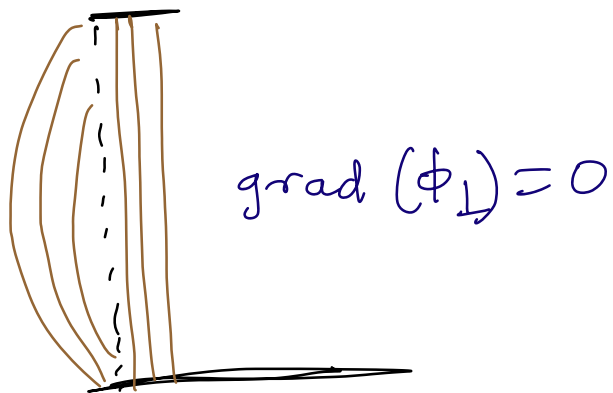
∴ Electric field normal to the straight line is Zero.
We can say that the gradient of normal component of potential Zero

→ In mathematical nomenclature prescribing the function at the Boundaries is also called as Dirichlet Boundary condition.

Also, prescribing the Normal Derivative at the Boundary is also called Neuman Boundary condition.

→ The same analysis is possible along the dashed lines that describe the

Boundaries of the Silicon Region



As for the potential we can state that the Electric potential is given at the contacts this constitutes a 'Dirichlet's Boundary condition

$$\text{i.e. } \phi = \phi_c$$

and that we are able to select the Insulating Boundaries in such a way as to provide Homogenous Neuman Condition on those Boundaries.

****** For the Electric potential the problem is well posed.

Now we have to discuss the Boundary Conditions of the Concentrations. $n + p$

If, we look at the Oxide off from the insulator

carrier concentrations are identically zero inside the oxide.

For, oxide region there is nothing to solve.

 Now, we will discuss what happens to the concentrations of n & p at the contacts Source & Drain and Bulk. Also what happens to the normal derivatives of n & p at the two insulating boundaries of the silicon region. ?

For contacts: The solution is relatively easy because, the contacts are made of Metals & they are rich of Free charge. They have plenty of electrons in them.

If we consider the semiconductor regions that are immediately attached to the contact. If that semiconductor region in some sense tries to depart from the condition of Charge Neutrality i.e. charge density

briefly become **Non-zero in the contacts**

The contact is immediately able to supply charge in order to restore Charge Neutrality.

→ So, we have a condition in which near the Source, Drain & Bulk we may impose a condition of **Equilibrium** → **Charge Neutrality** to the semiconductor near the contact.

→ If we have these two conditions we can calculate the value of **n & p** near the **Contacts**.

For n & p we have Dirichlet's condition at the Contact.

Now, only thing that's left is to discuss the n & p at the Insulating Boundaries.

⋮
⋮
⋮
⋮
⋮
⋮
⋮
⋮
⋮
⋮
→ **Reset two** ←

It is obvious that No current crosses the insulating boundary.

So, we may say that Normal component of J_n & J_p equal to zero.

$$J_{n\perp} = J_{p\perp} = 0$$

At the insulating boundaries of semiconductor

T. 25.26: Condizioni al contorno per i contorni isolanti.

$E = E_z$ Electric Field From Source to Bulk Drain to Bulk
 ν : unit vector Normal to the Insulating Boundary

Boundary Conditions for the DD Equations — I

Insulating Boundaries

The geometry of the problem to be solved can always be taken such that at the insulating boundaries $\Gamma_{i1}, \Gamma_{i2}, \dots$ it is

$$\mathcal{E} \cdot \nu = 0 \Rightarrow \frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial \nu} = 0, \quad \mathbf{r} \in \Gamma_{i1}, \Gamma_{i2}, \dots$$

At the insulating boundaries it is also $J_n \cdot \nu = J_p \cdot \nu = 0$ whence, combining with the above,

$$-q\mu_n n \frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial \nu} + qD_n \frac{\partial n}{\partial \nu} = 0 \Rightarrow \frac{\partial n}{\partial \nu} = 0, \quad \mathbf{r} \in \Gamma_{i1}, \Gamma_{i2}, \dots,$$

and similarly $\partial p / \partial \nu = 0, \mathbf{r} \in \Gamma_{i1}, \Gamma_{i2}, \dots$. In conclusion, at the insulating boundaries the boundary condition is the same for all the scalar unknowns φ, n, p :

$$\frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial \nu} = 0, \quad \frac{\partial n}{\partial \nu} = 0, \quad \frac{\partial p}{\partial \nu} = 0, \quad \mathbf{r} \in \Gamma_{i1}, \Gamma_{i2}, \dots,$$

i.e., of homogeneous Neumann type.

Since E & ν are $\perp$ then their Dot product i.e. scalar product is zero.

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~~***~~ We have

$$\vec{E} \cdot \vec{\nabla} = 0$$

We know

$$\vec{E} = E = -\text{grad}(\phi)$$

It can also be written as

$$\vec{E} = -\text{grad}(\phi) = -\nabla \phi$$

$$\nabla = \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial x} \hat{i} + \frac{\partial}{\partial y} \hat{j} + \frac{\partial}{\partial z} \hat{k} \right)$$

$$\vec{E} = -\nabla \phi = - \left(\frac{\partial \phi}{\partial x} \hat{i} + \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial y} \hat{j} + \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial z} \hat{k} \right)$$

Now

$$\vec{E} \cdot \vec{\nabla} = 0 \quad \text{implies}$$

$\therefore \vec{\nabla}$ is unit vector $\perp$ to
The Insulating Boundary

Assume The device in 3D

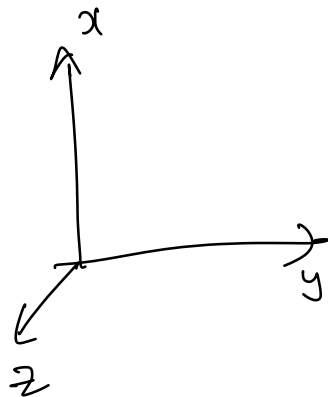
& $\vec{\nabla}$ should be along y-axis

$\therefore \vec{\nabla}$ is unit vector along y-axis

$\vec{E} = E =$ Electric field from
Source to Bulk

Co
Drain to Bulk

∇ = unit vector $\perp$ to
to the Insulating
Boundary



$$\vec{v} = \hat{j}$$

Now

$$E \cdot \vec{v} = 0 \Rightarrow - \left(\frac{\partial \phi}{\partial x} \hat{i} + \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial y} \hat{j} + \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial z} \hat{k} \right) \cdot \vec{v}$$

$$\Rightarrow - \left(\frac{\partial \phi}{\partial x} \hat{i} + \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial y} \hat{j} + \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial z} \hat{k} \right) \cdot \hat{j}$$

$$\Rightarrow - \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial y} (\hat{j} \cdot \hat{j})$$

$$\begin{aligned} \hat{i} \cdot \hat{j} &= \hat{i} \cdot \hat{k} = 0 \\ \hat{j} \cdot \hat{k} &= 0 \end{aligned}$$

$$\Rightarrow - \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial y} = 0$$

$$\therefore \vec{v} = \hat{j}$$

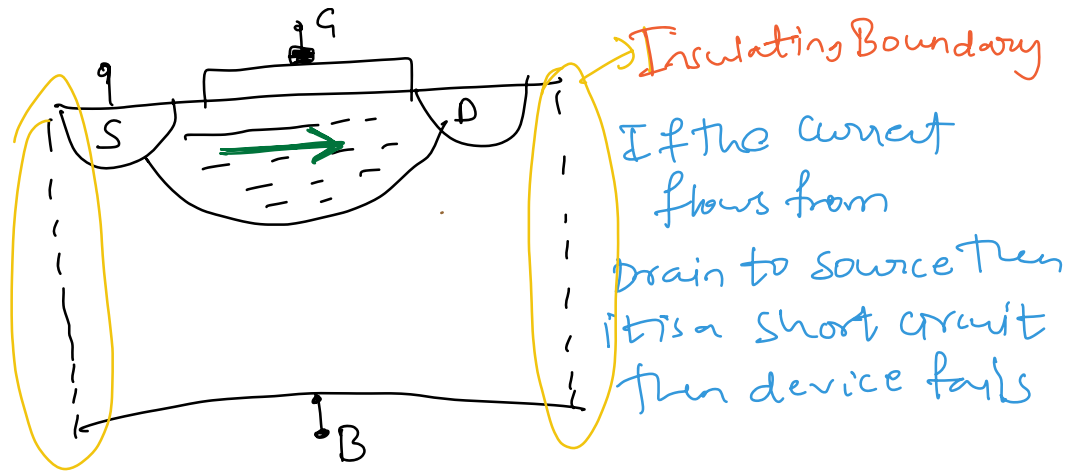
$$dy = dv$$

$$\frac{\partial \phi}{\partial y} = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow E \cdot \vec{v} = 0 \Rightarrow \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial y} = 0$$

This equation represents
variation w.r.to SPACE.

Note:- In a MOS device the current should always flow from source to drain and only in the channel.



There is small conduction happens in bulk because of minority charge carriers and it is quite small

$$-q\mu_n n \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial y} + qD_n \frac{\partial n}{\partial y} = 0 \Rightarrow \frac{\partial n}{\partial y} = 0$$

For an n-channel MOSFET with Bulk p-type
The current from source to Bulk
Drain to Bulk

is only from Minority Charge carriers
In this case Electrons of p-type Bulk.

Importantly: Source - Gate } Two Junctions are Reverse Biased
Drain - Gate }
That's why only current is due to minority carriers.

∴ Drift diffusion current from Drain to Bulk is due to Electrons

$$-q\mu_n n \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial y} + qD_n \frac{\partial n}{\partial y} = 0$$

Drift current $\downarrow$ as to insulating Boundary

Diffusion current $\uparrow$ as to insulating Boundary

$$\frac{\partial n}{\partial y} = 0$$

variation of n along the direction of y is zero

n : electron concentration

This whole calculation is related to the Insulating Boundary condition. Keep that in Mind.

Boundary Conditions for the DD Equations — I

Insulating Boundaries

The geometry of the problem to be solved can always be taken such that at the insulating boundaries $\Gamma_{i1}, \Gamma_{i2}, \dots$ it is

$$\mathbf{E} \cdot \boldsymbol{\nu} = 0 \Rightarrow \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial \nu} = 0, \quad \mathbf{r} \in \Gamma_{i1}, \Gamma_{i2}, \dots$$

At the insulating boundaries it is also $\mathbf{J}_n \cdot \boldsymbol{\nu} = \mathbf{J}_p \cdot \boldsymbol{\nu} = 0$ whence, combining with the above,

$$-q\mu_n n \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial \nu} + qD_n \frac{\partial n}{\partial \nu} = 0 \Rightarrow \frac{\partial n}{\partial \nu} = 0, \quad \mathbf{r} \in \Gamma_{i1}, \Gamma_{i2}, \dots,$$

and similarly $\partial p / \partial \nu = 0, \mathbf{r} \in \Gamma_{i1}, \Gamma_{i2}, \dots$. In conclusion, at the insulating boundaries the boundary condition is the same for all the scalar unknowns ϕ, n, p :

$$\boxed{\frac{\partial \phi}{\partial \nu} = 0}, \quad \boxed{\frac{\partial n}{\partial \nu} = 0}, \quad \boxed{\frac{\partial p}{\partial \nu} = 0}, \quad \mathbf{r} \in \Gamma_{i1}, \Gamma_{i2}, \dots,$$

i.e., of homogeneous Neumann type.

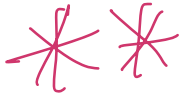
Conclusion ϕ , n & p have

normal derivative equal to ZERO
at the insulating Boundaries.

i.e Homogeneous Neumann
Condition

→ In other words Normal Derivative along
the unit vector $\vec{n}$ which is
 $\perp$ to the insulating Boundary.

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Another important thing we have to do is describing the coefficients of the mathematical model.

They are

D_n, D_p → Diffusion coefficients

U_p, U_p → Generation & Recombination coefficients
 G_n, G_p

→ we have also learned that Generation & Recombination is of the Thermal & Non-Thermal events separately.

Six different 1st order equations that need to be solved with different unknown

Semiconductor Equations — VI

Within the semiconductor region

$$\begin{aligned} \text{div } \mathbf{D} &= q(p - n + N), & \mathbf{D} &= -\epsilon_{sc} \text{grad } \varphi \\ \frac{\partial n}{\partial t} + U_n - \frac{1}{q} \text{div } \mathbf{J}_n &= G_n, & \mathbf{J}_n &= q\mu_n n \mathbf{E} + qD_n \text{grad } n \\ \frac{\partial p}{\partial t} + U_p + \frac{1}{q} \text{div } \mathbf{J}_p &= G_p, & \mathbf{J}_p &= q\mu_p p \mathbf{E} - qD_p \text{grad } p \end{aligned}$$

Within the insulator region

$$\begin{aligned} \text{div } \mathbf{D} &= q N_{ox}, & \mathbf{D} &= -\epsilon_{ox} \text{grad } \varphi \\ n = p &= 0, & \mathbf{J}_n &= \mathbf{J}_p = 0 \end{aligned}$$

They constitute a system of non-linear, partial differential equations of the first order, in the unknowns φ , n , p , and $\mathbf{D}$, $\mathbf{J}_n$, $\mathbf{J}_p$. The coefficients are μ_n , μ_p , D_n , D_p . The data are $N(\mathbf{r})$, $N_{ox}(\mathbf{r})$. In turn, U_n , U_p , G_n , G_p can be expressed as functions of the unknowns. By introducing the expressions of $\mathbf{D}$, $\mathbf{J}_n$, $\mathbf{J}_p$ into the divergence operator, one obtains a system of PDEs of the second order.

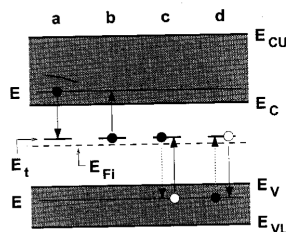
Capitolo 26



Generazione-ricombinazione

Net Thermal Recombination Rate — II

Shockley-Read-Hall theory



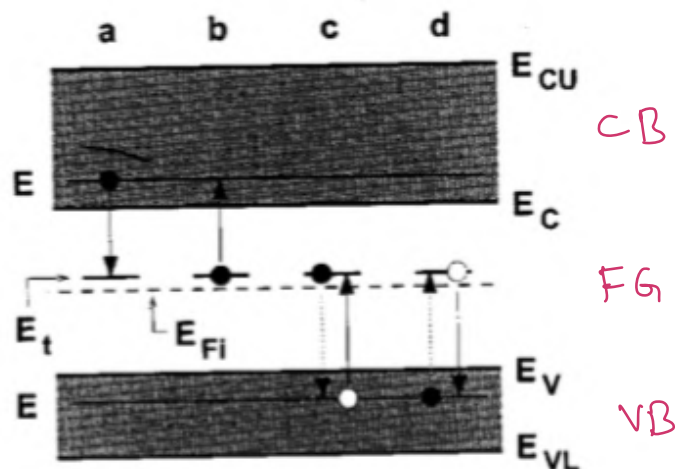
$$U_n = r_a - r_b = \alpha_n n N_t (1 - P_t) - e_n N_t P_t,$$

$$U_p = r_c - r_d = \alpha_p p N_t P_t - e_p N_t (1 - P_t),$$

where N_t is the concentration of traps and P_t is the occupation probability of a trap.

* This above figure refers to the Thermal generation & Recombination events. We have already had some short discussion of this issue at much earlier stage when we were discussing the Form of the Bands.

Now, we go to it in some more detail.



CB : Conduction Band

FG : Forbidden Gap

VB : Valence Band

→ It may happen that inside the Gap of the semiconductor. There are energy ^(FG)

states that are due to existence of some defect of the semiconductor, like Impurities, Defects in the lattice etc.

It is impossible to have semiconductor that is completely free of Defects.

→ Defects introduced by Dopants are very special, because states introduced due to Donor dopants are close to CB and the states that are introduced due to Acceptor dopants are close to VB.

Here, we are not considering above states. we are only considering other type of defects such that Energy states introduced by them are near the Middle of FB

i.e. close to

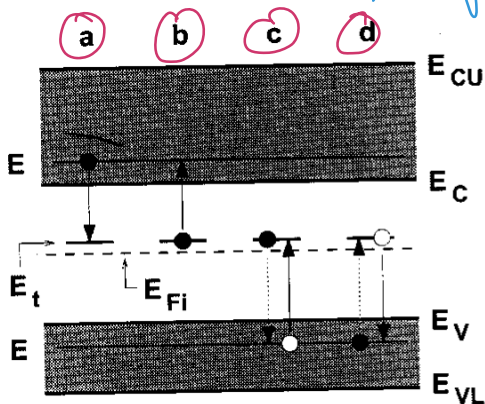
E_F Intrinsic Fermi level

→ Now, let's consider the transition of one electron from Conduction Band into the valence Band. It is called a Recombination event.

→ We have studied that recombination event may be Direct i.e. e^- jumps from CB to VB, releasing total energy of jump in one shot. This is called Direct Recombination.

→ The opposite phenomenon is which the e^- in VB absorbs enough Energy to jump into the CB. This is called Direct Generation of Electron-Hole pair.

→ There is another phenomenon i.e. also possible. If there is a Trap



case (a) The electron in CB. This electron may receive to the lattice enough energy to jump into the Trap with Energy level E_t (Trap Energy)

This electron stays for a while in the Trap unless if you look at the event labeled

(c) This e^- makes a 2nd transition from Trap into the VB

→ So, Globally if event (a) followed by event (c) globally is a Recombination event.

This is called Trap Assisted Recombination.

→ The inverse phenomenon is also possible an e^- initially in VB absorbs energy from the Vibrations of the lattice & goes into the Trap. This event (d) After this absorbs another block of

energy and goes up into the conduction band
this is called event of Type $\textcircled{b}$

$\textcircled{D}$ followed by $\textcircled{b}$ is called
Generation of an electron
hole pair.

→ All of these events are thermally activated
i.e. exchange of energy is within the
vibrating nuclei of the lattice.

→ $\textcircled{Q}$ Which of these events are more probable
Trap Assisted ones or Direct ones?

Ans trap Assisted ones are MUCH MUCH
likely to occur to the extent that
when we consider thermal generation
& recombination we neglect the
direct events. Because their probability
is negligible.

→ For Description of The Thermally Assisted Generation and Recombination Events it is sufficient to consider only one type of Traps. (All of them with same Energy)

This is simplified description but we shall see later that it's sufficient

→ But, we remember that when we start discussing about Energy states of The Gap in principle we have two types of them one is Donor Type & The other type is Acceptor Type. like in the Dopants These are not due to Dopants but they behave like Dopants.

They acquire (or) Release Electrons

→ The Donor Traps have the property that they are Neutral when they are filled with Electrons and they are +ve when they are Empty.

→ In contrast the Acceptor traps are neutral when empty and ~~are~~ when filled.

→ So in principle we should consider two more populations those of particles that are trapped in the Acceptor Type and particles that are trapped in Donor-type Traps

→ Therefore instead of considering only two populations electrons of the CB & Holes of the VB, For a moment will consider 4 populations

- (i) Electrons of CB
- (ii) Holes of VB
- (iii) Population of Acceptor Traps (considered as electrons)
- (iv) population of Donor Traps (considered as populated with holes)

→ In this case we will not write TVHO
but FOUR continuity equations.
and we shall simplify them almost
immediately

→

Net Thermal Recombination Rate — I

Continuity equations for bands and traps

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial n}{\partial t} + U_n - \frac{1}{q} \operatorname{div} \mathbf{J}_n &= G_n, & \frac{\partial p}{\partial t} + U_p + \frac{1}{q} \operatorname{div} \mathbf{J}_p &= G_p \\ \frac{\partial n_a}{\partial t} + U_{na} - \frac{1}{q} \operatorname{div} \mathbf{J}_{na} &= G_{na}, & \frac{\partial p_d}{\partial t} + U_{pd} + \frac{1}{q} \operatorname{div} \mathbf{J}_{pd} &= G_{pd} \end{aligned}$$

Acceptor Traps (electrons) Donor (Holes)

Let $G_n = G_p = G_{na} = G_{pd} = 0$. Adding over the current densities and observing that $\partial N(\mathbf{r})/\partial t = 0$ yields

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial [q(p + p_d - n - n_a + N)]}{\partial t} + \operatorname{div}(\mathbf{J}_p + \mathbf{J}_{pd} + \mathbf{J}_n + \mathbf{J}_{na}) &= \\ = U_n + U_{na} - (U_p + U_{pd}) = 0 &\Rightarrow U_n + U_{na} = U_p + U_{pd}. \end{aligned}$$

In crystalline silicon it is $\mathbf{J}_{pd} \simeq 0$, $\mathbf{J}_{na} \simeq 0$:

$$\frac{\partial n_a}{\partial t} = -U_{na}, \quad \frac{\partial p_d}{\partial t} = -U_{pd}.$$

In steady-state conditions this yields $U_{na} = U_{pd} = 0 \Rightarrow$

$$U_n = U_p \doteq U.$$

In equilibrium all continuity equations reduce to the identity $0 = 0$,
whence $U_n = U_{na} = U_p = U_{pd} = 0$.

Here, we have Four sets of Continuity Equations
for Bands & Traps.

n_a : Acceptor traps i.e electrons

J_{na} : current density because of electrons

G_{na} : Generation Term

U_{na} : Recombination Term

→ All these equations are used to determine the expression of Thermal Recombination Term.

So, we simplify the model by considering that there are no Non-Thermal Events

i.e $G_n = G_p = G_{na} = G_{pd} = 0$

→ After this we will add all the 4 equations by taking ^{equations of} Holes with +ve sign and equations of Electrons with -ve sign

$$\frac{\partial [q(p + p_d - n - n_a + N)]}{\partial t} + \text{div}(\mathbf{J}_p + \mathbf{J}_{pd} + \mathbf{J}_n + \mathbf{J}_{na}) = q(U_n + U_{na}) - q(U_p + U_{pd}) = 0 \Rightarrow U_n + U_{na} = U_p + U_{pd}.$$

** Now, we have a Global Continuity equation in which we have Time derivative of all contributions to charge density

we have population of Holes, electrons of Band & Traps.

i.e P, P_d, n, n_a, N
 Concentration of Dopant

$$\therefore \frac{\partial}{\partial t} q [P + P_d - n - n_a + N]$$

Time derivative of The Global charge density with all contributions present.

$$* \operatorname{div} (J_p + J_{pd} + J_{na} + J_n)$$

The divergence operator also includes all possible currents.

So This equation is The continuity equation
 Directly from Maxwell's equation $\therefore$
 it must be zero.

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t} q [P + P_d - n - n_a + N] + \operatorname{div} (J_p + J_{pd} + J_n + J_{na}) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow q (v_n + v_{na}) - q (v_p + v_{pd}) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow U_n + U_{na} = U_p + U_{pd}$$

This is a very fundamental result which can be found by Reasoning. Instead of doing a calculation.

→ All these transitions are transition of e^- 's on the left & The transitions of Holes on the right.

Transition of electrons must be Transition of Holes in opposite way so they must be equal.

→ we will introduce a simplification by observing nature of J_{pd} , J_{na}

J_{pd} :

J_{na} : current along the Traps

J_{na} →

— — — —

↙ Traps

(Q) is J_{na} possible?

Any In crystalline Si it's almost impossible

Because the only mechanism by which one electron can move from one Trap to another is The Quantum Effect called The Tunnel effect. The Tunnel effect becomes significant if two Traps are closer to each other.

In crystalline Si Traps are not so many
 $\therefore$ relative distance b/w Traps is large
 $\therefore$ this prevents Tunnel effect from occurring

In polycrystalline Silicon there are many Traps & Tunnel effect is very possible & Non negligible

$\therefore$ we neglect $\bar{J}_{pd}$, J_{na} & we have already neglected q_{na} & q_{pd}

$$\Rightarrow \frac{\partial n_a}{\partial t} + U_{na} = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \boxed{\frac{\partial n_a}{\partial t} = -U_{na}} \quad \& \quad \boxed{\frac{\partial p_d}{\partial t} = -U_{pd}}$$

→ In steady state condition i.e. nothing depends on time

$$U_{na} = U_{pd} = 0$$

because

$$\frac{\partial n}{\partial t} = 0$$
$$\frac{\partial p}{\partial t} = 0$$

$$U_n = U_p = U$$

Steady state

A common symbol for Thermal Recombination of electron & hole

* Now, the issue is to calculate the expression for U (Net Thermal Recombination rate)

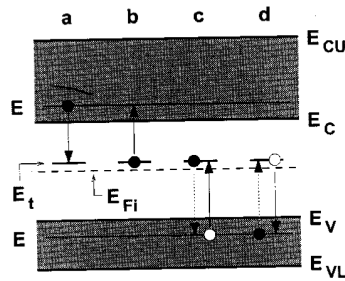
The calculation that provides for the net thermal recombination rate U is due to

SHOCKLEY - Read - Hall THEORY

what we do is treating separately the possible events that occur to determining $U_n + U_p$

In the figure we assume that there is only one type of traps & the traps have same energy E_t

Shockley-Read-Hall theory



$$U_n = r_a - r_b = \alpha_n n N_t (1 - P_t) - e_n N_t P_t,$$

$$U_p = r_c - r_d = \alpha_p p N_t P_t - e_p N_t (1 - P_t),$$

where N_t is the concentration of traps and P_t is the occupation probability of a trap.

The Concentration of Traps have a concentration in space i.e. N_t

Then we distinguish first event (a)
i.e. CB to Trap

→ we know electrons don't like to stay together
so for these electrons to make these
transitions The Trap should be Empty
if the Trap is filled it is impossible for electron
from CB to make this transition

→ Then we have Transition event (b)

e^- from Trap to CB, obviously
Total event of Type (a) + Total event of

Type (b) per unit volume in time giving you the Net Recombination Rate of the Conduction Band

→ Then we have events of (c) in which one electron initially belonging to a trap makes a transition into the empty state of the valance Band. This is also described as Transition in the opposite direction of a hole (i.e. hole initially in the valance Band transitions into a state)

→ Finally, we have an electron in the VB going into an empty trap that we can describe as opposite transition of a hole from the empty trap into the Band.

∴ events (c) & (d) per unit volume in Time provide the net recombination rate of the VB

Now, let's give some names to the rates.

$$r_a = \frac{\text{No. of events of Type (a)}}{\text{unit volume in time}}$$

Similarly r_b, r_c, r_d are described

$$\therefore U_n = r_a - r_b$$

$$U_p = r_c - r_d$$

Remember we are in a Nonequilibrium condition.

In Equilibrium $U_n = U_p = 0$ because continuity equations are identically zero.

So the probability of occupation of the electron state cannot be described using Fermi statistics.

The probability of occupation is unknown.

→ Specifically P_t is the probability of electron occupying the traps

P_t is Unknown in Non-Equilibrium condition.

→

$$U_n = r_a - r_b = \alpha_n n N_t (1 - P_t) - e_n N_t P_t,$$

$$U_p = r_c - r_d = \alpha_p p N_t P_t - e_p N_t (1 - P_t),$$

where N_t is the concentration of traps and P_t is the occupation probability of a trap.

what we will do is find individual expressions for $\tau_a, \tau_b, \tau_c, \tau_d$ and will eventually derive U_n, U_p



we find the expression for $\tau_a, \tau_b, \tau_c, \tau_d$ heuristically.

τ_a : no. of transitions of type (a) for unit volume in time

No. of electrons that are initially in the conduction band

→ One may argue that no. of transitions would be proportional to the no. of electrons that are present in the conduction band.

$$\therefore \tau_a \propto n \left(\text{concentration of electron in CB} \right)$$

→ But also, it is intuitive that no. of transitions are more if the traps are larger.

If we have no traps we have no transitions.

$$\therefore \tau_a \propto \underbrace{N_t (1 - p_t)}_{\text{signifies the traps that are empty}}$$

we have

$$\tau_a \propto n$$

$$\tau_a \propto N_t (1 - p_t)$$

$$\Rightarrow \boxed{\tau_a = \underbrace{\alpha_n}_{\text{transition coefficient}} n N_t (1 - p_t)}$$

$\alpha_n \rightarrow$ it describes the interaction b/w the electron and the trap.

~~**~~ τ_b : No. of transitions of type b
from the logical reasoning we followed

in the earlier

$$r_b \propto N_t P_t \rightarrow \text{No. of filled traps}$$

$$\Rightarrow r_b \propto \text{probability of empty state in CB}$$

which is practically equal to one.

$$r_b = e_n N_t P_t$$

emission coefficient

Similarly for r_c & r_d we follow the same logic.

$$\Rightarrow r_c = \alpha_p P N_t P_t$$

Hole from VB to Trap

$$r_d = e_p N_t (1 - P_t)$$

Hole from Trap to VB

$$U_n = r_a - r_b = \alpha_n n N_t (1 - P_t) - e_n N_t P_t,$$

$$U_p = r_c - r_d = \alpha_p p N_t P_t - e_p N_t (1 - P_t),$$

if $\alpha_n, \alpha_p, e_n, e_p$ are known then
we could easily calculate U_n, U_p

we also have a relationship b/w

$$\begin{aligned} e_n &\propto \alpha_n \\ e_p &\propto \alpha_p \end{aligned}$$

→ At equilibrium condition

$$U_n = U_p = 0$$

∴ at equilibrium $r_a = r_b$ &
 $r_c = r_d$

→ On the other hand at equilibrium

n & p are known because

They are equilibrium carrier concentrations of e^- 's & holes

P_t becomes Fermi Statistics at Equilibrium

→ This allows us to find relation b/w emission coefficient & Transition coefficient.

$$U_n = r_a - r_b = \alpha_n n N_t (1 - P_t)$$

At equilibrium

$$- e_n N_t P_t = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \alpha_n n N_t (1 - P_t) = e_n N_t P_t$$

$$\Rightarrow e_n P_t = \alpha_n n^{eq} (1 - P_t)$$

$$e_n = \alpha_n n^{eq} \left(\frac{1}{P_t} - 1 \right)$$

Similarly

$$\alpha_p P^{eq} = e_p \left(\frac{1}{P_t} - 1 \right)$$

Net Thermal Recombination Rate — III

Shockley-Read-Hall theory

In equilibrium it is $U_n = U_p = 0 \Rightarrow$

$$e_n = \alpha_n n^{\text{eq}} \left(\frac{1}{P_t} - 1 \right), \quad \alpha_p p^{\text{eq}} = e_p \left(\frac{1}{P_t} - 1 \right).$$

$$P_t = \frac{1}{(1/d_t) \exp[(E_t - E_F)/(k_B T_L)] + 1} \Rightarrow$$

$$\frac{1}{P_t} - 1 = \frac{1}{d_t} \exp[(E_t - E_F)/(k_B T_L)]$$

$$e_n = \alpha_n \frac{n^{\text{eq}}}{d_t} \exp[(E_t - E_F)/(k_B T_L)] = \alpha_n n_B$$

$$e_p = \alpha_p p^{\text{eq}} d_t \exp[(E_F - E_t)/(k_B T_L)] = \alpha_p p_B$$

e_n & α_n
are not
independent

In steady-state conditions $U_n = U_p = U \Rightarrow r_a - r_b = r_c - r_d :$

$$\alpha_n n (1 - P_t) - \alpha_n n_B P_t = \alpha_p p P_t - \alpha_p p_B (1 - P_t).$$

One finds

$$P_t = \frac{\alpha_n n + \alpha_p p_B}{D}, \quad 1 - P_t = \frac{\alpha_n n_B + \alpha_p p}{D}$$

$$\text{with } D = \alpha_n (n + n_B) + \alpha_p (p + p_B)$$

E_t : Trap Energy (we have to know the position of the traps)

d_t : Degeneracy coefficient

n^{eq} : Electron concentration at equilibrium

$$n_B = \frac{n^{\text{eq}}}{d_t} \exp\left[\frac{(E_t - E_F)}{k_B T_L}\right]$$

Similarly p_B is defined

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→ we know in Non-Equilibrium Condition

$$U_n = U_p$$

There is a provision that the relation U_n & U_p have been found in Equilibrium condition Q Are they still valid in Non-Equilibrium Condition?

It can be shown that approx. they are valid.

→ Now in Non-Equilibrium Condition we take

$$U_n = r_a - r_b = \alpha_n n N_t (1 - P_t) - e_n N_t P_t$$

$$U_p = r_c - r_d = \alpha_p p N_t P_t - e_p N_t (1 - P_t)$$

$$\& U_n = U_p$$

In steady-state conditions $U_n = U_p = U \Rightarrow r_a - r_b = r_c - r_d$:

$$\alpha_n n (1 - P_t) - \alpha_n n_B P_t = \alpha_p p P_t - \alpha_p p_B (1 - P_t).$$

One finds

$$P_t = \frac{\alpha_n n + \alpha_p p_B}{D} \quad 1 - P_t = \frac{\alpha_n n_B + \alpha_p p}{D}$$

$$\text{with } D = \alpha_n (n + n_B) + \alpha_p (p + p_B)$$

$$P_t = \frac{\alpha_n n + \alpha_p p}{D}$$

expression for probability
of occupation of
Trap

So, we can express P_t without introducing
additional unknowns into the Model.

$$1 - P_t = \frac{\alpha_n n_B + \alpha_p p}{D}$$

Then we take P_t & $(1 - P_t)$ & replace
them back into the below expressions

$$U_n = r_a - r_b = \alpha_n n N_t (1 - P_t) - e_n N_t P_t,$$

$$U_p = r_c - r_d = \alpha_p p N_t P_t - e_p N_t (1 - P_t),$$

where N_t is the concentration of traps and P_t is the occupation
probability of a trap.

→ Since $U_n \neq U_p$ are equal eventually
we will obtain a common expression of
for $U_n \neq U_p$.

Net Thermal Recombination Rate — IV

Shockley-Read-Hall theory

Replacing P_t and $1 - P_t$ in $U = \alpha_n n N_t(1 - P_t) - \alpha_n n_B N_t P_t$ yields

Common expression for $U_n \neq U_p$

$$U = N_t \frac{\alpha_n n (\alpha_n n_B + \alpha_p p) - \alpha_n n_B (\alpha_n n + \alpha_p p_B)}{\alpha_n (n + n_B) + \alpha_p (p + p_B)} =$$

$$= \frac{np - n_B p_B}{(n + n_B)/(N_t \alpha_p) + (p + p_B)/(N_t \alpha_n)},$$

with $n_B p_B = n_i^2$. If the semiconductor is non degenerate, it is $n_B p_B = n_i^2$ and

$$n_B = \frac{N_C}{d_t} \exp\left[-\frac{E_C - E_t}{k_B T_L}\right], \quad p_B = N_V d_t \exp\left[-\frac{E_t - E_V}{k_B T_L}\right]$$

In such case the denominator of U has a sharp minimum for

$$E_t = \frac{1}{2}(E_C + E_V) + \frac{1}{2}k_B T_L \log\left(\frac{\alpha_p N_V}{\alpha_n N_C} d_t^2\right) \simeq \frac{1}{2}(E_C + E_V) \simeq E_{Fi},$$

whence $n_B \approx p_B \approx n_i$.

→ In the Non-Degenerate case

$$n^{eq} = N_C \exp(E_F - E_C)$$

effective density of states of CB

$$e_n = \alpha_n \frac{n^{eq}}{d_t} \exp[(E_t - E_F)/(k_B T_L)] \doteq \alpha_n n_B$$

$$e_p = \alpha_p p^{eq} d_t \exp[(E_F - E_t)/(k_B T_L)] \doteq \alpha_p p_B$$

From this we know $n_B \neq p_B$

$$n_B = \frac{n^{eq}}{d_t} \exp[(E_t - E_F)/k_B T_L]$$

$$\therefore n^{eq} = N_C \exp(E_F - E_C)$$

$$n_B = \frac{N_C \exp(E_F - E_C)}{d_t} \exp((E_t - E_F)/k_B T_L)$$

$$n_B \Rightarrow N_C \exp\left(\frac{E_C - E_t}{k_B T_L}\right)$$

Similarly

$$p_B = N_V d_t \exp\left[-\frac{(E_t - E_V)}{k_B T_L}\right]$$

→

$$n_B p_B = n_i^2$$

In the non-degenerate case so, it does not contain the energy of the trap anymore

So, Globally The Numerator of does not

$$U = N_t \frac{\alpha_n n (\alpha_n n_B + \alpha_p p) - \alpha_n n_B (\alpha_n n + \alpha_p p_B)}{\alpha_n (n + n_B) + \alpha_p (p + p_B)} =$$

$$= \frac{np - n_B p_B}{(n + n_B)/(N_t \alpha_p) + (p + p_B)/(N_t \alpha_n)},$$

contain Energy of the Trap. But the Denominator does have Trap Energy (E_t)

→ when we started The Analysis we said we always have traps in the Gap. Then Direct transitions would be Negligible because Trap Assisted Transitions are only one that are important.

The point is we made calculations assuming there is only ONE LEVEL OF TRAPS.

మనం ఏది పరిశీలించినా ఒక సులభతరమైన మార్గాన్ని మొదట ఎంచుకుంటాం.

ప్రతి జవాబుకు మొదటి అడుగు ఇలానే వెళ్ళాలి.

తరువాత అంచెలంచెలుగా ప్రశ్న తీవ్రతను పెంచాలి.

ఇది మన జీవన విధానంలో చాలా బాగా ఉపయోగ పడుతుంది.!

ఇట్లు మీ

— రేవంత్ రెడ్డి పన్నెల

Revanth Reddy Pannala

ఇవన్న వీక్లీ గణాంక

(EBIT)

→ In Reality, we may have many layers of traps with different Trap Energies

Q What should we do Now?

In principle, we should Repeat the calculation for each trap Energy that is present in the semiconductor and Sum up the results. It is very inconvenient - we are not gonna do it.

→ If we look at the expression

$$U = N_t \frac{\alpha_n n (\alpha_n n_B + \alpha_p p) - \alpha_n n_B (\alpha_n n + \alpha_p p_B)}{\alpha_n (n + n_B) + \alpha_p (p + p_B)} =$$
$$= \frac{np - n_B p_B}{(n + n_B)/(N_t \alpha_p) + (p + p_B)/(N_t \alpha_n)},$$

we ask ourselves

Q How does U depend on Trap Energy E_t ?

In the expression of n_B & p_B we have

E_t

i.e. n_B & p_B depend on E_t exponentially

More precisely $n_B \propto \exp(\underline{E_t - E_c})$

As $E_t - E_c \uparrow$ $n_B \uparrow$

Similarly

$$p_B \propto \exp^{-(E_t - E_v)}$$

As $(\underline{E_t - E_v})$ becomes more and more -ve
 $p_B \uparrow$

Therefore The Denominator of U in almost all cases depends exponentially on the Trap level.

→ So, we may assume this analysis where we take value of Trap Energy that provides the minimum of the denominator for U

so that U will be Maximum.

→ When we go away from this specific E_t for which we have maximum U , the denominator will increase exponentially that it will kill ' U ' the Recombination Function.

→ Actually the Trap level that's important is the one for which the denominator is minimum

It's easy to calculate the Minimum of Denominator because they are just exponentials

→ We take the derivative of the Denominator w.r.t E_t and then we put it equal to zero & we get

$$E_t = \frac{1}{2} (E_c + E_v) + \frac{1}{2} k_B T_L \log \left(\frac{\alpha_p N_v}{\alpha_n N_c} \right) d_t^2$$

small

$$\approx \frac{1}{2} (E_c + E_v) \approx E_{Fi}$$

when $n_B \approx p_B = n_i$ Intrinsic Fermi Level

So we ^{keep} traps at the Mid-gap as the most efficient ones

→ Given the above simplifications we can still manipulate the expression of U a bit.

In the Denominator we have $N_t \alpha_p + N_t \alpha_n$

$$U = N_t \frac{\alpha_n n (\alpha_n n_B + \alpha_p p) - \alpha_n n_B (\alpha_n n + \alpha_p p_B)}{\alpha_n (n + n_B) + \alpha_p (p + p_B)} =$$

$$= \frac{np - n_B p_B}{(n + n_B)/(N_t \alpha_p) + (p + p_B)/(N_t \alpha_n)},$$

we know N_t : Is a concentration

α_n, α_p are dimensionary volumes over time

so $\left. \begin{array}{l} N_t \alpha_n \\ N_t \alpha_p \end{array} \right\}$ they are inverse of Time

Net Thermal Recombination Rate — V

Shockley-Read-Hall theory

Defining the lifetimes

$$\tau_{p0} = \frac{1}{N_t \alpha_p}, \quad \tau_{n0} = \frac{1}{N_t \alpha_n} \Rightarrow$$

$$U \doteq U_{\text{SRH}} = \frac{np - n_i^2}{\tau_{p0}(n + n_B) + \tau_{n0}(p + p_B)}.$$

In equilibrium it is $U = 0$. Recombination (generation) dominates where $U > 0$ ($U < 0$). $\rightarrow$ Because $np > n_i^2$

Limiting cases

- Full depletion: $n, p \ll n_i, n_B, p_B \Rightarrow$

$$U \simeq -\frac{n_i^2}{\tau_{p0} n_B + \tau_{n0} p_B} \simeq -\frac{n_i}{\tau_{p0} + \tau_{n0}} \doteq -\frac{n_i}{\tau_g},$$

- Weak injection: $|n - n^{\text{eq}}|, |p - p^{\text{eq}}| \ll c^{\text{eq}}$, where c^{eq} is the equilibrium concentration of the majority carriers.

$$U > 0 \quad \text{Recombination is Dominant}$$

$$U < 0 \quad \text{Generation is Dominant}$$

→ we use the formula for U in future it depends on n & p it does not introduce any additional unknowns on the other hand U is non-linear w.r to n & p

→ In analytical calculation it's possible to simplify U in some special cases

Limiting cases

- Full depletion: $n, p \ll n_i, n_B, p_B \Rightarrow$

$$U \simeq -\frac{n_i^2}{\tau_{p0} n_B + \tau_{n0} p_B} \simeq -\frac{n_i}{\tau_{p0} + \tau_{n0}} \doteq -\frac{n_i}{\tau_g},$$

- Weak injection: $|n - n^{eq}|, |p - p^{eq}| \ll c^{eq}$, where c^{eq} is the equilibrium concentration of the majority carriers.

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Net Thermal Recombination Rate — VI

Shockley-Read-Hall theory

- Weak injection, n-type semic.: $|n - n^{\text{eq}}|, |p - p^{\text{eq}}| \ll n^{\text{eq}}$.

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Numerator} \leftarrow \left\{ \begin{aligned} np - n_i^2 &\simeq n^{\text{eq}}(p - p^{\text{eq}}) + p^{\text{eq}}(n - n^{\text{eq}}) \\ \text{Denominator} \leftarrow \tau_{p0}(n + n_B) + \tau_{n0}(p + p_B) &\simeq \tau_{p0} n^{\text{eq}} \end{aligned} \right. \Rightarrow \end{aligned}$$

$$U \simeq \frac{p - p^{\text{eq}}}{\tau_{p0}} + \frac{n - n^{\text{eq}}}{(n^{\text{eq}}/p^{\text{eq}})\tau_{p0}}.$$

$$\tau_n \doteq \frac{n^{\text{eq}}}{p^{\text{eq}}} \tau_{p0} \gg \tau_p \doteq \tau_{p0} \Rightarrow U \simeq \frac{p - p^{\text{eq}}}{\tau_p}$$

- Weak injection, p-type semic.: $|n - n^{\text{eq}}|, |p - p^{\text{eq}}| \ll p^{\text{eq}}$.

$$\left\{ \begin{aligned} np - n_i^2 &\simeq n^{\text{eq}}(p - p^{\text{eq}}) + p^{\text{eq}}(n - n^{\text{eq}}) \\ \tau_{p0}(n + n_B) + \tau_{n0}(p + p_B) &\simeq \tau_{n0} p^{\text{eq}} \end{aligned} \right. \Rightarrow$$

$$U \simeq \frac{p - p^{\text{eq}}}{(p^{\text{eq}}/n^{\text{eq}})\tau_{n0}} + \frac{n - n^{\text{eq}}}{\tau_{n0}}.$$

$$\tau_p \doteq \frac{p^{\text{eq}}}{n^{\text{eq}}} \tau_{n0} \gg \tau_n \doteq \tau_{n0} \Rightarrow U \simeq \frac{n - n^{\text{eq}}}{\tau_n}$$

$$\Rightarrow np - n_i^2$$

$$\Rightarrow [(n - n_{eq}) + n_{eq}] [(p - p_{eq}) + p_{eq}] - n_i^2$$

$$\Rightarrow \underbrace{(n - n_{eq})(p - p_{eq})}_{\text{This term is quite small}} + p_{eq}(n - n_{eq}) + n_{eq}(p - p_{eq})$$

This term is quite small

$$+ \underbrace{n_{eq} p_{eq} - n_i^2}_{\text{Both cancel out}}$$

Both cancel out

$$\Rightarrow p_{eq}(n - n_{eq}) + n_{eq}(p - p_{eq}) \approx np - n_i^2$$

Numerator.

- Weak injection, n-type semic.: $|n - n^{eq}|, |p - p^{eq}| \ll n^{eq}$.

$$\text{Denominator} \left\{ \begin{array}{l} np - n_i^2 \approx n^{eq}(p - p^{eq}) + p^{eq}(n - n^{eq}) \\ \tau_{p0}(n + n_B) + \tau_{n0}(p + p_B) \approx \tau_{p0} n^{eq} \end{array} \right. \Rightarrow$$

we ignore Holes because it's n-type semiconductor

$$U \approx \frac{p - p^{eq}}{\tau_{p0}} + \frac{n - n^{eq}}{(n^{eq}/p^{eq})\tau_{p0}}$$

$$\tau_n \doteq \frac{n^{eq}}{p^{eq}} \tau_{p0} \gg \tau_p \doteq \tau_{p0} \Rightarrow U \approx \frac{p - p^{eq}}{\tau_p}$$

Because $n - n^{eq} \approx 0$
(increased weak Injection)

Conclusion: If we are in weak injection condition and if the material is n-type then the Recombination Rate (U) is entirely dependent on the minority charge carriers i.e. Holes

$$U \approx \frac{p - p^{eq}}{\tau_p}$$

Similarly for p-type semiconductor

- Weak injection, p-type semic.: $|n - n^{eq}|, |p - p^{eq}| \ll p^{eq}$.

$$\begin{cases} np - n_i^2 \simeq n^{eq}(p - p^{eq}) + p^{eq}(n - n^{eq}) \\ \tau_{p0}(n + n_B) + \tau_{n0}(p + p_B) \simeq \tau_{n0}p^{eq} \end{cases} \Rightarrow$$

$$U \simeq \frac{p - p^{eq}}{(p^{eq}/n^{eq})\tau_{n0}} + \frac{n - n^{eq}}{\tau_{n0}}.$$

$$\tau_p \doteq \frac{p^{eq}}{n^{eq}}\tau_{n0} \gg \tau_n \doteq \tau_{n0} \Rightarrow U \simeq \frac{n - n^{eq}}{\tau_n}$$

Usefulness

→ So, it is Linearization of U and U depends only on one type of carriers because of this it becomes possible we shall see many examples.

Each time we can apply weak injection condition & we can decouple the Equation of the model from one another because we have U dependent on one type of carriers.

* This concludes the analysis of Thermal Recombination that are the most important ones.

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